

the least you can do is invest in a reference book or visit your local library for an all-round view of the subject. If that course website has forums, actively participate in them and interact with other students from across the globe. Don't just limit yourself to the video or audio lectures from the course. Go out and explore the subject.

► **Understand on your current college course**

Free online courses are not just an addition to the course that you're already doing or have done in the past. They can even help you grasp concepts which you may not have understood in college. By visiting different online courses, you'll be exposed to different methods of teaching, and some methods may help you understand your school/college coursework better than others. How we wish there was a Khan Academy while we were in school. It would have made understanding Physics so much easier!

Free Online Education Resources

Now that you've got the preliminary pointers out of the way, the next step is looking for a free online course. The best way to go about this is to Google the term 'free online courses' and voila! It will link you courses galore.

If you're looking at a specific university's courses, then the best bet is to visit that particular university's website and search for the term 'open courses' or 'free online courses'. Beware that a renowned university won't offer all of its courses for free. If that was the case, there wouldn't be students running from pillar to post to procure enough capital to enroll in an international university. The courses offered for free vary from one university to another. Some of the courses may just be introductory ones, which will give you a basic feel of the subject. Still other places may offer courses in niche disciplines such as Cryptography.

We've selected a sprinkling of some of the best websites offering free online education.

Udacity

- Website: <http://www.udacity.com/>
- Universities Associated: None.
- No. of Courses Offered: 11
- Certifications (if any): Yes (Paid)
- Discussion Forums: Yes
- Video Lectures: Yes